Using testee responsibly: instructions for companies

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For owners and admins of a company on testee. These are testee's instructions for use under the EU AI Act (Art. 13). Your own duties as an employer, under the employment and data protection law that applies to you, stay yours.

1. What testee is and is for

- **Provider:** Arcolabs OÜ, above. **You** (the company that tests candidates) are the deployer.
- **Intended purpose:** testing job candidates' knowledge for one role with a timed multiple-choice interview, to help the people at your company decide whom to take further. AI writes the questions from your job description (up to half of a topic may be proven questions from testee's own templates or its shared question bank, never ones shown publicly for practice); you review the topics; each candidate's answers are marked against a fixed answer key.
- **High-risk AI system.** Under the EU AI Act, a system used to evaluate candidates is high-risk (Annex III point 4(a)), and testee is treated as one. Its obligations apply from 2027-12-02; before then testee signs its EU declaration of conformity and is registered in the EU database, and from 2027-11-02 the CE marking is shown in the site footer, linked to the declaration.
- **Not for:** see section 11.

2. What a testee grade is

- The **percentage of points earned**, over every question the candidate was shown. Each question is worth one point:
    - most questions have one right option of four: 1 point when it's picked, 0 otherwise;
    - about 1 in 10 are **"select all that apply"** (shown as such to the candidate): 2 or 3 of the 4 options are right and the candidate ticks every option they think is right. Any wrong option ticked scores 0; otherwise the question earns the share of its right options ticked (2 of 3: 0.67 of a point). Each candidate gets the same share of these questions.

  With single-answer questions alone, the grade is the percentage answered correctly. A question with nothing picked when its timer ran out counts as wrong. Candidates can change their pick until they move on; only the final one is kept.
- Each answer is marked against the question's **answer key**. No AI marks answers, and nothing else (speed, page leaves, copy attempts) changes the grade. If a question's key is found to be wrong and corrected, the fix applies to candidates who start after it; answers already given, and their grades, don't change.
- **Green or red** only compares the grade with the passing grade you set. **The ranking** sorts by grade, best first.

- **Explaining a grade:** the candidate's scorecard shows every question, the options picked, right or wrong, the points of a "select all that apply" question ("2 of 3 right options · 0.67 of 1 point"), the time taken, and the integrity signals. That is everything the grade comes from.

3. Accuracy and its limits

- **Declared accuracy:** a correct answer key for **at least 98% of questions**, single-answer and "select all that apply" alike (for the latter, every option correctly marked right or wrong). Measured in testee's offline evaluations, checked by an AI judge: 99% for single-answer questions (240 questions in 8 fields, 2026-10-04; 98% had exactly one defensible answer) and 98.5% for "select all that apply" questions (268 of them on 48 subtopics, 2026-10-17). The key checker caught 60 of 60 single-answer and 263 of 263 "select all that apply" wrong keys planted on purpose. Every new "select all that apply" question is also answered again blind, and dropped if that answer differs from its key or it leaves a deciding condition unstated. A change of model or prompt that misses the target isn't released without a reason.
- **What that means for a grade:** the grade counts points against the key. A key found wrong is fixed for candidates who start afterwards; grades already given are never marked again, so a candidate may have answered a question whose key was later corrected (section 5).
- **In use:** before an interview is ready, one answer key per topic is checked again. After 30 answers, a question is flagged and fixed or replaced when it is answered right by 15% or fewer, by 95% or more (for a "select all that apply" question, by its average points), when a wrong option is picked more often than the key (than its least-picked right option), when strong and weak candidates get it right about equally often, or when time runs out on a quarter of its showings; also after 2 reports of the same problem.
- **What a grade is not:** a measure of overall ability, experience, potential, personality or fit; a qualification or certificate.
- **Not exactly comparable between candidates:** each one gets a different random set of questions from the same bank, so small differences (a few points) can come from the draw.
- **Not free of error:** a question can still be wrong or unclear, especially in a new interview before about 30 people have answered it.
- **Language and reading speed:** when the interview is timed and not in the candidate's first language, it also tests those. Choose the interview's language with your candidates in mind.
- **Groups of candidates:** testee collects no data about candidates' sex, age, origin or disability, so it can't measure results by group for you. An independent bias audit of testee is done before 2027-12-02 and every year after, and its summary published at testee.ai/documents.
- **Job performance:** testee doesn't learn how hired candidates do in the job, so it doesn't show that a grade predicts job performance.

4. What testee needs from you (input)

- A job description, or a description of the role, that names what the job actually needs. Only what is in it becomes topics.

- Your review of the topics before questions are written: uncheck what the job doesn't need, rename or edit, then approve. The approval is recorded.
- A passing grade and average time per question that fit the role (section 6).

5. Human review: your duty

People at your company make the hiring decision. testee never tells a candidate they were rejected.

- **Give the review to people who understand testee:** these instructions, especially sections 2, 3 and 7, are what they need to know.
- **Before rejecting anyone on a testee result, a person must open their scorecard** and look at the answers, not just the grade, colour or rank.
- Use the grade **alongside** other information (CV, work samples, interviews), not as the only gate.
- If a question looks wrong, report it with **Wrong answer**: testee checks its answer key again, usually within a day, and tells you when it's fixed. Take that into account for candidates who already answered it.
- **Candidates can ask you for a human review** of their result (testee tells them so on the invite page, and reminds you on the results page and in PDF reports). Name who handles these requests, reply within a reasonable time, and be ready to explain what was tested and how the result was used.
- In the EU, a decision based solely on automated processing that significantly affects a candidate is restricted (GDPR Art. 22). Rejecting automatically everyone below the passing grade can be one.
- The same applies to results testee sends to the tools you connect: your applicant tracking system, Slack, or your own systems through the API and web hooks receive the grade, and your applicant tracking system and own systems whether it reached the passing grade. **Don't set them up to reject candidates automatically** on those results; the human review above applies there too.
- **The assistant and AI apps.** testee's in-app assistant acts only after the member confirms each change. AI apps (Claude, ChatGPT and others) a member connects act with that member's access, and the data they read goes to that app's provider. Owners and admins can turn AI apps off for the company (Integrations → AI apps → **Allow AI apps**). The same human review applies to results read through them. Both answer with AI and can misstate or leave out part of a result: before acting on what they say about a candidate, check the candidate's scorecard, and don't let them decide about a candidate. They don't change grades; they read what testee recorded.

6. Choosing a passing grade

- The default 70% is a starting point, not a recommendation for your role.
- Try the interview yourself first (**Try as a candidate**, free). Ask one or two people who do the job well to try it too: their grades show what "good" looks like.
- Set the passing grade from what the role needs, and write down why. Don't raise it to cut volume.
- Treat grades near the passing grade (for example within 5–10 points) as a band that deserves a closer look, not a hard cut.
- Keep the same passing grade for every candidate of the same interview.

7. Integrity signals

Page leaves, copy attempts and answers under 3 seconds are **hints, not proof**. A notification, an accessibility tool, a slow connection or a fast expert can all trigger them. They're reported by the candidate's browser, and a page leave counts only when it lasts 2 seconds or more (a shorter one, such as a notification or a permission prompt taking focus, is kept but not counted). Never reject on signals alone; follow up in a conversation, and let the candidate explain.

Once a candidate has finished every section, their page can also show **answer patterns**, read from their answers and times alone (no camera, microphone, screen recording, device fingerprint or IP address):

- **Timing:** answer times about the same on every question, instead of following each question's own time and its difficulty. It needs at least 8 answers given in time.
- **Unusual pattern:** hard questions right while easy ones were wrong, shown with the counts. It needs at least 8 questions whose difficulty is known (a question's share of right answers once 30 candidates have answered it).

Both are set so that at most 1% of honest candidates show them in testee's tests on made-up candidates; they catch about a third of candidates who relay every question to an AI. A pattern can have innocent causes (a steady pace, gaps in what someone has learned, a lucky guess), so it's a reason to ask, never proof. Patterns don't make the candidate "flagged" in the list, the ATS or web hooks; the PDF report and the API show which patterns appeared.

For every finished candidate, the page also suggests up to 3 questions they got right to talk through in a live interview ("Why is X right and Y not?"), from their strongest topics, and first the hard ones behind an unusual pattern. Use them to hear the candidate's reasoning in their own words; they appear only on the candidate's page.

8. Accommodations and extra time

- Tell candidates, before they start, how to ask for an accommodation (the candidate notice templates include this).
- testee's invite page tells candidates to ask you for more time before they start.
- For a candidate who asks, set **extra time: +25%, +50% or +100%** on every question's timer, on the candidate's page. It can be set or changed only **before the candidate starts**, so agree it first. testee stores only the amount, never the reason. Their grade is compared with the same passing grade.
- Candidates who come through your shareable link can't get extra time there: the page tells them to ask you for a personal invite first. Invite them by email instead.
- If timed multiple choice doesn't suit the candidate's needs at all (for example some screen-reader or motor impairments), offer an **alternative assessment** outside testee. Don't ask for medical details beyond what you need.
- You can also raise the average time per question for everyone in the interview's settings; each question's own time grows with it.
- testee's candidate pages are built to WCAG 2.2 AA.

- **Voice mode** (an interview's setting, in English, Spanish, German, French, Portuguese or Italian) reads each question and its options aloud and lets candidates answer aloud. It can help some candidates (some visual or motor impairments, a phone), but speech recognition can mishear an accent, a speech impairment or a noisy room: the interviewer says the option it heard and shows it on screen ("B, saved." for a single answer; a choice of several options is confirmed first), only a reply that clearly names one option is saved without asking, and tapping an option always works. Tell candidates before they start, and set an interview to click mode for anyone who prefers it. testee turns the speech into text and options only, never stores it and never analyses the voice (no tone, emotion or confidence; the EU AI Act bans inferring emotions in the workplace, recruitment included).
- In the **UK**, the Equality Act 2010 asks you to make reasonable adjustments for disabled candidates; in the **US**, the ADA asks for reasonable accommodation. Extra time, an alternative assessment and click or voice mode are the adjustments testee gives you.

9. Telling candidates

Before you invite, tell candidates that they will take a timed AI-generated knowledge test, what it covers, how the result is used, that page leaves and copies are recorded, that they confirm answering on their own before they start, how long data is kept, and how to ask for an accommodation, an alternative or a human review. testee's candidate notice templates (at testee.ai/documents) are a starting point. testee's invite page also tells candidates what to expect and links testee's privacy policy, but the notice about **your** use of the results is yours to give.

- **People you find on the Discover tab** chose to be open to offers and gave you no data themselves: you got their name, LinkedIn profile and practice results from testee. Tell them, at the latest in your invite and within a month, who you are, why you're contacting them, what you saw and their rights (GDPR and UK GDPR Art. 14). Use what you see only to consider them for your own jobs, and remember their results are practice, not a qualification.
- Until testee has verified your company, your invite pages and emails say so in a small line. Use **Verify company**: your website, and a sign-in with an email on its domain.
- testee's invite and reminder emails let candidates stop your company's emails, or that interview's reminders, with a link at the bottom. Once a candidate stops your company's emails, testee doesn't email them for your company again: an invite to them shows as undelivered in the candidate list, so reach them another way if you still need to.

- **Candidates from your own platform.** Through the API your platform can invite a candidate with `sign_in` false: testee then sends them no emails, and they take the interview from their invite link without signing in to testee, so the notice and the link are yours to send, to that candidate only (anyone with the link can use it). The invite can also set a `return_url`, a **Back to** your company button on the finished page, and a `theme` (light, dark, or the candidate's own). testee's SDK (testee.ai/embed/v1.js) shows the interview inside your own page. The return button may lead to any https address. The embedded interview works only on the domains your company allows on its API page's SDK tab (localhost only when you allow it, to try it on your own computer); the API and web hooks don't depend on those domains: each key can be limited to your servers' IP addresses instead. Verification isn't needed for them, nor for the API or AI apps: it only adds the verified badge. The candidate still sees testee's invite page, in your company's logo and colors if you set them, before they start. Leaving the embedded interview, also for the rest of your page, counts as a page leave. The developer docs (testee.ai/api-docs) give the details.

10. Records, retention and data requests

Records (logs). For each candidate testee records every question shown and when, the picks, right or wrong (or the points of a "select all that apply" question), the time taken, timeouts, page leaves (with how long they lasted) and copy attempts, start and finish (in voice mode, the options the candidate chose, never what they said): the scorecard and its PDF report show them, and the API returns the results. Answer patterns aren't stored: they're read from these records each time the results are opened. It also records when the candidate confirmed, before starting, that they'd answer on their own, which the scorecard shows. Your company's action log records every action your members take: on interviews (created, renamed, settings, shareable link, topics approved, passing grade), on candidates (invited, revoked, deleted, renamed, extra time, results viewed, reports emailed), on the team, the company, billing and integrations (ATS, Slack, API keys and web hooks), with who acted, when, and whether they acted in the app, through the assistant, an AI app, the API or an ATS. The owner reads it on the company's **Action log** tab, filtered by member, kind of action and days, or through the API (`GET /companies/{id}/audit`). Keep what your law requires: the EU AI Act asks you to keep these records at least six months, and testee keeps them for you as below. Download PDF reports to keep them longer: some laws ask for more than testee's 12 months, such as California's rules on automated-decision systems in employment (4 years, from 2025-10-01), Colorado's AI law (3 years, from 2027-01-01) and US federal rules on hiring records (1 year from the record or the personnel action, whichever is later, and until any charge is settled). Team notes on an interview stay with it until you delete them or the interview, also after the candidate they name is deleted.

Retention.

- Candidate results, timings and signals are **deleted automatically 12 months after the invite** was last sent.
- Invites never started expire after 30 days: they can't be used, and their email stays until the 12 months above.
- Candidates your applicant tracking system sends (their email, name and ATS ids, and their result until it has gone back to the system) are kept 12 months.
- The action log is kept 12 months.

- Job description text is kept 90 days in generation records; the interview stays until you delete it.
- A candidate's request to stop your company's emails is kept, as a one-way hash of their email address, until you delete the company, also after you delete the candidate. A hash of an address that bounced or marked an email as spam stays until testee removes it, so it isn't emailed again.
- Candidates' ratings and reports of questions stay with the question, or until the candidate deletes their account.
- Notifications in your members' bells, which can show a candidate's email and grade, are kept up to 90 days. A web hook still being retried holds its data up to 3 days.
- Backups hold deleted data for at most 14 more days.
- PDFs you download, and results sent to your applicant tracking system, Slack or your own systems, are yours to keep and delete under your own retention policy.

Data requests. You are the controller of candidates' interview data; testee is your processor under the data processing agreement at testee.ai/dpa, which is part of the terms.

- **Access:** open the candidate's **scorecard page** and download their **PDF report**. Together they hold everything testee keeps about the interview: each question, their answer (every option ticked), right or wrong or the points it earned, time taken, page leaves and copy attempts, any answer patterns, and the grade. Send the PDF, with your own explanation of how it was used.
- **Erasure or objection:** on the candidate's page, revoke an unused invite, or use **Delete candidate** for one who started or finished: their answers and results are deleted for good, also from the bell and from testee's record of them for your applicant tracking system, and credits still held come back (a candidate who answered at least one question stays charged). Team notes that name them aren't touched: edit those yourself. Copies already sent to your applicant tracking system, Slack or your own systems are yours to delete there.
- If a candidate writes to testee instead, testee passes the request on to you.
- Candidates can also download what is linked to their own testee account with **Download my data** in Settings.

11. Where not to use testee

- As the **only** basis for a rejection without human review.
- For skills a multiple-choice knowledge test can't measure (manual, interpersonal, creative work) or knowledge the job doesn't actually need.
- For promotion, termination, performance monitoring or task allocation of employees.
- For candidates under 16.

- For **New York City** roles, before you have done what Local Law 144 asks of you as the employer: a bias audit by an independent auditor within the year before use, its summary published, and a notice to candidates at least 10 business days before they are assessed. testee gives you the bias-audit export for your auditor (the owner downloads it from the Action log page: each finished candidate's id and email, the interview, the day they finished, their grade, the passing grade, whether they passed and whether they scored above the interview's median, for you to add your candidates' own self-reported categories and remove the id and email before you share it), the summary of its own bias audit, and a notice template.
- Where your local law requires a works council agreement, a regulator approval or a bias audit you haven't done.

testee treats itself as an automated employment decision tool under Local Law 144 whenever the grade or the passing grade is used to screen, rank or reject candidates: a numeric score that substantially assists a hiring decision. Used only as one input among others that people weigh more, it may not be one, but count on the duties above.

11a. The UK and the US

- **UK:** the UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018 apply as the GDPR does: a lawful basis, a DPIA (the Information Commission, which still goes by ICO, treats AI in recruitment as high risk) and the candidate notice. A significant decision taken solely by automated means needs safeguards: information about it, a way to make representations, human intervention and a way to contest it (Arts. 22A to 22D UK GDPR, as the Data (Use and Access) Act 2025 made them from 2026-02-05). With a person who really decides, these are good practice rather than a legal duty; the ICO's March 2026 report Recruitment rewired warns of calling a tool decision support when little human involvement remains. The ICO's recommendations for AI recruitment tools (2024) also ask you to check the tool's accuracy and bias with its provider, to collect no more than needed, and to keep candidates' data no longer than needed. Avoid indirect discrimination under the Equality Act 2010: choose topics and a passing grade the job really needs (sections 4 and 6), and watch pass rates.
- **US federal:** Title VII and the ADA apply to tests used in hiring. Check adverse impact on your own outcomes (the four-fifths rule of thumb in the Uniform Guidelines, 29 CFR 1607.4(D): a group's pass rate under 80% of the highest group's is a warning sign; the bias-audit export in section 11 gives the outcomes to join with your own data), and give reasonable accommodation. The EEOC is rescinding its copy of the Guidelines and no longer brings disparate impact cases, but disparate impact stays in Title VII and candidates can still sue.
- **New York City:** section 11.
- **Illinois** (Human Rights Act, from 2026-01-01): tell candidates when AI is used in recruitment or hiring decisions, and never use AI that discriminates by a protected class, or zip codes as a proxy for one (testee asks for neither). No rules on the notice have been adopted yet, so follow the statute. Use the Illinois notice template.

- **Colorado** (its automated decision-making law, SB 26-189, which replaced the 2024 AI Act, from 2027-01-01; the Attorney General's rules aren't final): before using testee on Colorado candidates, give the pre-use notice; within 30 days of an adverse decision, explain the decision and testee's role, how to ask for the tool's name, version and developer and the data used and its sources, and the candidate's rights to correct factually wrong personal data and to ask for human review where commercially reasonable; keep records 3 years from the decision. Use the Colorado notice template; testee's documentation for deployers is this document, the technical facts in section 3 and the DPIA template. testee trains no AI model and puts no candidate's data into training: questions come from OpenAI's general-purpose models and your job description, and the grade comes from answer keys, not from a trained model.
- **California:** the Civil Rights Council's rules on automated-decision systems (from 2025-10-01) make you answer for discrimination through such tools, value anti-bias testing, and ask you to keep their records 4 years; the privacy agency's rules on automated decision-making technology, for businesses under the CCPA where a tool replaces or substantially replaces a person's decision, ask for a pre-use notice, and access and opt-out rights (with exceptions for a human appeal and for tools that only assess ability to do the work), for significant decisions such as hiring, from 2027-01-01. A person who understands the result, weighs it and can change the decision keeps you outside them. testee is your service provider under the CCPA (the data processing agreement's US section).
- **New Jersey** (N.J.A.C. 13:16, from 2025-12-15): disparate impact rules under the Law Against Discrimination cover automated employment decision tools; you can be liable even if a vendor built the tool.
- **Texas** (HB 149, from 2026-01-01): AI used with the intent to discriminate is banned; a disparate impact alone doesn't show that intent.

12. Your duties as a deployer under the EU AI Act

Already now, take measures to support the AI literacy of the staff who use testee (Art. 4), and explain, on request, the role it played in a decision about a candidate (Art. 86: the move to 2027 leaves this article out).

From 2027-12-02, when you use testee in the EU:

- use it as these instructions say, and give human review to people with the competence and authority for it (section 5);
- make sure the job description and topics are relevant to the role (section 4);
- watch how it works for you, tell testee at once of a serious problem (below), and if it presents a risk, stop using it and tell testee and the market surveillance authority (Art. 26(5));
- keep the records for at least six months (section 10);
- tell workers' representatives and affected workers before you use it at the workplace, as your national rules set out (Art. 26(7));
- tell candidates that a high-risk AI system is used to assess them (section 9);
- in voice mode, rely on what testee does: speech turned into text only, never emotion recognition, which Art. 5 forbids in the workplace, recruitment included;

- use these instructions for your data protection impact assessment (testee's DPIA template at testee.ai/documents).

13. Availability, changes and support

- **What it needs:** a current web browser; candidates are best on a computer. Nothing to install.
- **Maintenance:** testee runs and updates it. During a maintenance break the site is closed and candidates' timers stop, so no one loses time. In an emergency testee can pause new interviews; candidates already in one can finish.
- **Lifetime and updates:** testee is a hosted service with no set end of life: testee maintains it for as long as it offers it, and updates it continuously, with nothing for you to install or do. A new AI model or prompt is released only after it meets the accuracy target in section 3. If testee ever stops offering the service, you are emailed in advance, with time to download your results.
- **Changes:** questions are improved continuously (section 3); a fix applies only to candidates who start after it. A change to how grades are worked out or to these instructions is published here with a new version date. A significant change to the terms or the data processing agreement is emailed to you at least 14 days before it applies.
- **Security:** sign-in with Google, LinkedIn or GitHub and a verified email; only the invited email can start an invite, except an invite your platform sent through the API without sign-in, which anyone with its link can use; roles limit what admins and viewers can do; API keys are kept only as hashes.

Reporting serious problems

Tell testee at once at hello@testee.ai if a result may have harmed a candidate (for example a wrong answer key behind a rejection), you see signs of unfair results for a group of candidates, or anything looks like a security problem. testee investigates, and reports serious incidents to the authorities when the law requires it.

Questions: hello@testee.ai.